



SAFETY TOOLBOX TALK

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Topic:			Environmental Awareness		

This briefing is not intended to tell you how to do your jobs, it is designed to help keep you safe. We want everybody to be able to return home safely to their family and friends at the end of each day.

In recent years it has been impossible to avoid hearing about the global environmental problems such as:

- Global Warming
- Destruction of Tropical Rain Forests
- Continuing increase in CO2 emissions
- Increasing extinction rates.

What can we do to help?

- Turn off lights when not in use.
- Switch off equipment when not in use
- Report maintenance issues/problems
- User greener transport/fuels
- Car share, share lifts
- Save energy!
- Recycle!

There are 4 main reasons for supporting a 'Greener' Environment.

1. Moral - Doing your bit for the environment.
2. Legal - Environmental laws are here and getting stricter.
3. Financial - Efficient use of resources means saving money.
4. Loyalty - Environmentally friendly companies enjoy a good reputation.

Moral

All businesses use energy, water and materials such as paper. If each UK Company made just 5 fewer photocopies per day, we would save 2,500,000 reams of paper. This would mean:

- Felling 200,000 fewer trees
- Reducing the amount of landfill space being taken up
- Reducing the amount of process energy, chemicals and transportation involved in paper manufacture.

Legal

There is now more environmental legislation at National and European level than ever before. Most pollution incidents or breaches of waste laws are the result of poor awareness or poorly controlled procedures.

IGNORANCE IS NO DEFENCE. Courts take a very severe view of environmental offences.

**Financial**

The efficient use of resources means saving money.

- Reduce Energy Consumption
- Routine and regular maintenance
- Reducing CO2 emissions

Loyalty

Environmentally friendly companies enjoy a better reputation. Increasingly many large companies are looking to suppliers who take account of environmental issues. Ensures Corporate Responsibility Policies are adhered to.

What are we doing to support the Environment?

Supply equipment from greener suppliers, reducing packaging, rainwater Collection Recycling:

- Paper
- Plastics
- Cardboard
- Aluminium Cans

DO YOUR BIT FOR THE ENVIRONMENT – RECYCLE, REUSE & REDUCE**Discussion Points**

Why should we support a greener environment?

What can you do to help?

What are you going to do differently as a result of this Toolbox Talk?